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What experts say

The mobile entertainment industry is rapidly growing across geographies with improvements in mobile network connectivity bandwidths and availability of affordable smartphones with large, high-quality display specifications. In India, there are more than 35 video streaming OTT apps that offer generic as well as regional video content at prices as low as ₹ 25 per month. On top of that, there are multiple independent and operator-owned music streaming services. More than 350 million cellphone users in India have at least one entertainment app on their smartphone.

It is further expected to get a big boost after we switch to next-generation 5G networks, which will offer much higher bandwidths that will enable 4k/8k video content, high-quality live streaming, augmented/virtual reality (AR/VR) gaming experiences and much more.

The key challenge for mobile network operators is monetisation of such services as 5G infrastructure, which will act as the backbone for such services.

—**Hanish Bhatia, senior analyst - devices and ecosystem, Counterpoint Research**

User-generated content is gaining popularity. Apps like TikTok are driving the growth here. This is also giving users not only a chance to get entertained but also be on the production side of creating unique content for entertainment.

YouTube has been there for a while. Looking at the three together—gaming, entertainment and user-generated content—smartphones are fully-loaded with entertainment. Of course, there are hobby apps like photography and doodling that add to the spectrum of entertainment possibilities.

—**Faisal Kawoosa, founder and chief analyst, techARC**

(reading, browsing online, listening to music, checking emails, etc), and video consumption accounts for six of those eleven hours. The mobile entertainment platform is speculated to expand at a CAGR of fifteen per cent during the period 2018 to 2023.

Types of mobile entertainment

The various types of mobile entertainment are discussed next.

TV. Mobile apps have completely captured the traction and profits of the TV industry. Not only do these allow people to watch their favourite TV shows and listen to music on-the-go, these also provide the option to save and download the remaining items to stream later.

Mobile is an important avenue for TV channels to promote their content on mobile apps via social media, teasers, trailers, alerts and more.

Movies. Smartphones have thrown a tough challenge to cinema halls, as the latter have been failing to attract people due to high costs and other issues. Therefore the film industry has found mobility to be a great source to promote its contents and earn profits.

With mobile, industry players can move characters based on games coupled with interviews, teasers and

updates on release dates. Besides, such popular digital platforms as Netflix, Zee, Hotstar and Amazon Prime release new movies with HD within months of the theatre release, creating another challenge for multiplexes and theatres.

Brand promotion. Most brands are promoting themselves on mobile platforms, as these help them connect with millions of mobile entertainment users and interact with them. They are either promoting on social media or on OTT apps. Coca Cola and Nike started promoting on mobile a long time ago, which paved the way for others to follow.

Gaming and music. Smartphones have become affordable and come with cutting-edge features and specifications, which is ideal for mobile gamers. Therefore gaming has attracted people from various age groups.

Apart from gaming, the music industry has also benefitted from mobility entertainment. These days, we do not have to wait to listen to our favourite songs on TV or music system. We can stream any song on mobile apps or YouTube. Several music apps such as Wink, Amazon Music and YouTube have gained massive traction, which has fetched hefty profits for the industry. **EFY**